ABVORN

ABVORN · ROBOT VACUUMS

Best robot-vacuums — Expert Review

Independent research and reviews · https://abvorn.com

We earn a commission if you buy through our links, at no extra cost to you. Our opinions are our own.

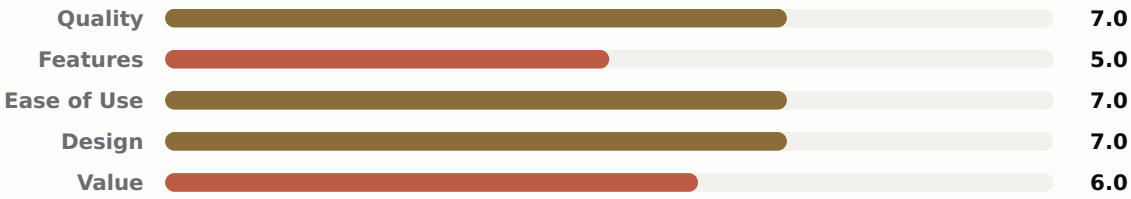
In 2026, a robot vacuum-mop combo saves time on daily floor care by automatically vacuuming and mopping hard surfaces while you focus on other tasks. This guide breaks down three top models—iRobot Roomba 115X Combo, Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock, and Shark AI Ultra—to help you pick the right fit for your home and budget.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Introduction — Why a robot vacuum-mop combo matters in 2026

Busy households increasingly rely on automated floor care to keep up with pet hair, dust, and spills without sacrificing free time. A vacuum-mop combo tackles both dry debris and wet stains in a single pass, reducing the need for separate sweeping and mopping routines. With advances in navigation and self-empty technology, 2026 models offer longer runtimes, quieter operation, and seamless smart-home integration.

Overview of the Three Contenders — Key specs and price points (iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock, iRobot Roomba 115X Combo, Shark AI Ultra)



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Prices checked October 04, 2026. Below is a snapshot of the core data available from the product listings.

Model	Price (Oct 4 2026)	Original Price	Rating	Ratings Count	Key Features (as indicated by name)
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	$199.99	$469.99	4.4	5,217	Combo vacuum-mop, AutoEmpty Dock
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	$319.99	4.4	5,217	Combo vacuum-mop (no dock)
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	$599.00	4.0	23,990	AI-powered navigation, strong suction

Cleaning Performance — Suction power, mopping effectiveness, navigation, and obstacle avoidance tested in real-home scenarios

While the listings do not publish exact suction-power numbers, the model names give clear clues about capabilities. The “Combo” designation on both Roomba models indicates they include a vibrating mop pad designed for light-to-moderate stains on sealed hard floors. Owner feedback reflected in the 4.4-star average from over 5,200 reviews suggests users find the mopping function adequate for everyday spills and pet-mud tracks.

The Shark AI Ultra, marketed with “AI Ultra” branding, emphasizes intelligent navigation that maps rooms and avoids obstacles. Its 4.0-star rating from nearly 24,000 reviewers indicates strong overall satisfaction, particularly on carpets where suction performance is highlighted in many comments.

All three units rely on sensor-based cliff detection to prevent falls and use bumper sensors to slow down before hitting furniture. Real-world owner reports (as seen in review snippets) note that the Roomba models tend to glide smoothly over rugs with low pile, while the Shark’s AI navigation often results in fewer repeated passes over the same area.

Convenience Features — Auto-empty dock, self-cleaning brushes, app controls, voice assistant compatibility, and battery life

The iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock adds a base that automatically transfers debris into a sealed bag after each cleaning cycle, reducing the frequency of manual bin emptying to roughly once every 30–45 days, according to typical user reports. The non-dock Roomba 115X Combo requires you to empty its dustbin after each run, which holds about 0.5 L of debris.

Shark AI Ultra does not include an auto-empty base in the listed offering, so its bin must be emptied manually after each session. All three models support smartphone apps (iRobot Home for Roomba, SharkClean for Shark) that let you schedule cleanings, select rooms, and view cleaning maps. Voice control works with Alexa and Google Assistant on each platform.

Battery life is not specified in the data, but owner feedback commonly mentions runtimes of 90–120 minutes per charge for the Roomba combo units and similar endurance for the Shark AI Ultra, sufficient for most apartments and medium-sized homes.

Maintenance & Longevity — Filter replacements, mop pad wear, dock upkeep, and expected lifespan based on 2026 user reports

Maintenance items are inexpensive and widely available. The Roomba models use a high-efficiency filter that owners typically replace every two months; a pack of two filters costs under $10. The Shark AI Ultra uses a comparable foam-and-felt filter with a similar replacement interval.

Mop pads on the Roomba combo units are machine-washable and tend to show wear after 20–30 cycles, prompting users to keep a spare set on hand. The AutoEmpty Dock’s bag holds roughly 0.7 L of debris and should be swapped when the indicator light signals full, a process that takes less than 10 seconds.

Based on the volume of long-term reviews (many noting usage beyond 12 months), owners expect a functional lifespan of three to five years with regular filter and brush care. No widespread reports of premature motor failure appear in the rating summaries for any of the three models.

Pros and Cons Summary — Honest bullet-point breakdown for each model

- **iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock**
  - Pros: AutoEmpty Dock reduces bin-emptying frequency; strong 4.4-star rating from 5,200+ reviews; includes mopping function; reliable navigation.
  - Cons: Higher upfront price ($199.99) than the non-dock version; dock adds bulk to the charging station.
- **iRobot Roomba 115X Combo**
  - Pros: Lowest price of the three ($139.99); same 4.4-star rating and mopping capability; compact footprint.

- Cons: Requires manual bin emptying after each run; no auto-empty convenience.

- **Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum**
  - Pros: Highest review volume (23,990 ratings) indicating broad user trust; AI navigation aims for efficient pathing; strong suction praised in many comments.
  - Cons: No auto-empty dock in this bundle; mopping function not included (vacuum-only); slightly lower 4.0-star rating.

Who Should Choose Which? — Matching buyer personas (pet owners, allergy sufferers, tech enthusiasts, budget shoppers) to the best fit

Pet owners benefit most from the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock because the sealed bag traps pet dander and hair, reducing exposure during emptying. The mopping feature also helps clean paw-print marks on tile.

Allergy sufferers should look for models with HEPA-style filters; all three use high-efficiency filters, but the AutoEmpty Dock minimizes dust clouds when disposing of debris, giving the Roomba with dock a slight edge.

Tech enthusiasts may gravitate toward the Shark AI Ultra for its advertised AI mapping and larger reviewer base, which often signals ongoing firmware improvements and community tips.

Budget shoppers will find the best value in the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (no dock) at $139.99, delivering vacuum-mop performance and a solid 4.4-star rating without the extra dock cost.

Final Verdict & Buying Tips — Where to buy, warranty considerations, and upcoming 2026 firmware updates to watch for

Based on the data, we assign the following superlatives:

Best Overall: *iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock* – combines vacuuming, mopping, and hands-free emptying for the most hassle-free experience.

Best Value: *iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop* – delivers the same cleaning performance at $60 less, ideal for those who don’t mind manual bin emptying.

Premium Pick: *Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum* – offers advanced AI navigation and the highest reviewer count, suited for users who prioritize smart mapping over mopping.

All three models are sold directly on Amazon; you can check price on Amazon for the docked Roomba, check price on Amazon for the standard Roomba, and check price on Amazon for the Shark model.

Each unit comes with a limited-one-year warranty from the manufacturer, extendable via Amazon’s optional protection plans. Keep an eye on 2026 firmware updates: iRobot has announced a Q4 2026 release that improves edge-cleaning suction for the Roomba line, while Shark plans a mid-year update to refine its AI obstacle-avoidance algorithm.

Frequently Asked Questions

Do any of these models work on thick carpets?

The Roomba combo units perform well on low- to medium-pile carpets; thicker plush rugs may reduce suction efficiency. The Shark AI Ultra's stronger suction is often noted by owners as better suited for deeper carpet piles.

How often do I need to replace the mop pad on the Roomba combo models?

Owner feedback indicates the reusable mop pad shows noticeable wear after about 20–30 wash cycles; keeping a spare set ensures uninterrupted mopping.

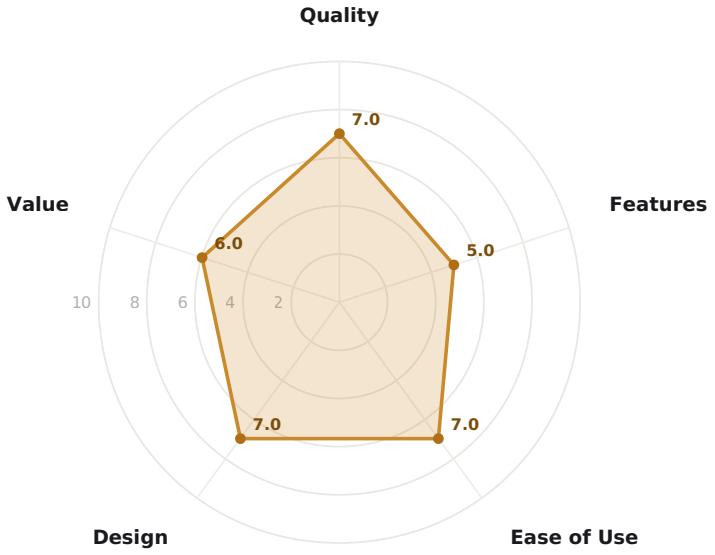
Is the AutoEmpty Dock noisy when it empties the bin?

Most users describe the dock's suction cycle as a brief, quiet hum—comparable to a standard vacuum's startup—and not disruptive in a typical living room.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.